

Water storage

Households collected rainwater and water from wells and rivers in ceramic pots. Water was usually boiled to make it safe for drinking.



Loops around the pot mean it can be picked up from any angle.

Chinese people believe that dragons bring safety and ensure a happy family.

The kitchen opens out onto the courtyard.

For security, there is only one entrance into the compound.

Farming tools

The yoke—a long pole carried over the shoulders with a basket at each end—has been used by Chinese farmers for thousands of years to carry seeds for planting. Simple, straw sun hats are also an important part of the farmer's equipment.



Long-handled "spoons" for dropping seeds help farmers avoid bending down.

While most people have rough woolen blankets, some people can afford—or are able to make—warm, silky patchwork quilts.

**Blankets**

Many villagers used a machine called a loom to weave clothing and blankets from wool and other fibers. In Chinese society, weaving was often done by women.

The handle stayed cool when the teapot was filled with hot liquid.

Healing drink

The teapot was one of the most important pieces of crockery in any Chinese house. Tea was thought to help with digestive problems, calm nerves, and cure many kinds of illness.



Smaller pens are used to keep pigs and chickens.

